

FINAL PROPOSAL

UWC-TKEthics Olympiad 2026 Proposal

The Model Philosophy Ethics Olympiad leadership team will take full responsibility for hosting and organising the event, as well as facilitating and coordinating the use of external judges from [TKEthics](#). The proposed date for this event is sometime in November 2026, however is flexible due to potential scheduling conflicts for either the activities office or the other UWC participants.

Objectives

The UWC-TKEthics Olympiad would provide an excellent platform for High School students to develop critical thinking skills and ethical reasoning in a supportive environment. The event will facilitate connections between UWC students across the globe through a shared love for philosophy and will foster a global sense of community through constructive competition. It also aims to promote respectful dialogue and strengthen intercultural exchange and understanding.

Participants

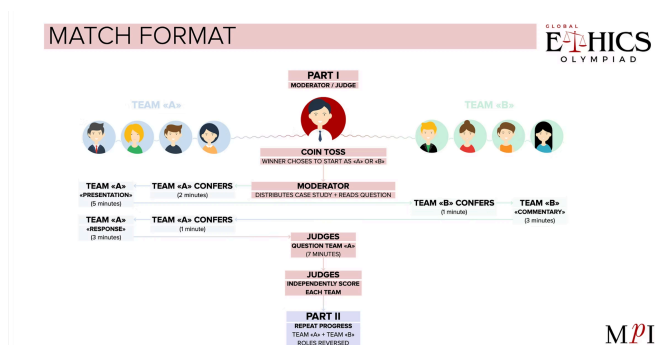
This competition will be hosted on Zoom, with ten participating teams composed of 4-5 students with a maximum of 32 teams; all of which will be high school students from international UWC schools. The intended participants for this competition are students from existing ethical, philosophical or debate societies in UWCs around the world, or those interested in all facets of ethical debate and active, collaborative discussion.

Format of Competition

The competition will be held online via Zoom. Teams will be separated into breakout rooms during each round of the actual competition and will communicate with each other through other personal online communication methods of their choice (WeChat, WhatsApp, etc.).

Structure

The structure of our online olympiad will follow the standard Model Philosophy Olympiad structure, consisting of 4 rounds. The debate will begin with either Team A or Team B beginning with a 5 minute 'presentation' surrounding their main arguments and counter-arguments, and then the opposing team will be given the opportunity to provide 'commentary' in the form of constructive suggestions to further discussion. The initial team will then respond to that commentary as well as a 'Judge's Questions' section.



Case Preparation

The eight ethical cases that will be the primary focus of the debate will require preparation in advance. Cases would be sent to participants five weeks before the date of the competition to allow sufficient time; all of these cases will be chosen by the MPEO leadership team from previous TKEthics case packages to ensure that all eight will cover diverse and thought-provoking topics.

Judging Criteria

We will adopt the official judging criteria used by TKEthis to ensure professionalism and fairness of judging.

HIGH SCHOOL ETHICS OLYMPIAD SCORE SHEET	
TEAM A Team A Presentation (First case)	TEAM B Team B Presentation (Second case)
A. Was Team A's presentation clear and systematic? (1-5) B. Did the team's presentation identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case? (1-5) C. Did the team's presentation indicate both awareness and thoughtful consideration of different viewpoints, including those that would form large in the reasoning of individuals who disagree with the team's position? (1-5)	A. Was Team B's presentation clear and systematic? (1-5) B. Did the team's presentation identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case? (1-5) C. Did the team's presentation indicate both awareness and thoughtful consideration of different viewpoints, including those that would form large in the reasoning of individuals who disagree with the team's position? (1-5)
1. Team A presentation score (Total A-C above)	2. Team B presentation score (Total A-C above)
of 15	of 15
3. Team A response to commentary	3. Team B response to commentary
of 15	of 15
4. Team A response to Judges' questions	4. Team B response to Judges' questions
of 15	of 15
6. Team A commentary	6. Team B commentary
of 10	of 10
9. Team A respectful dialogue	9. Team B respectful dialogue
of 5	of 5
10. TOTAL	10. TOTAL
of 60	of 60
Comments for Team A:	Comments for Team B:

2022 Ethics Olympiad Scoring Criteria

The Ethics Olympiad scoring criteria are based on the cases in competition with the ethics cases. These criteria are designed to be used by judges to evaluate the quality of the cases and to provide feedback to the teams. The criteria are designed to be used by judges to evaluate the quality of the cases and to provide feedback to the teams. The criteria are designed to be used by judges to evaluate the quality of the cases and to provide feedback to the teams.

Part 1: PRESENTING Team's Initial Presentation (15 Points Total)

(1) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(2) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(3) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(4) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(5) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(6) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(7) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(8) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(9) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(10) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(11) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(12) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(13) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(14) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(15) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

Part 2: RESPONDING Team's Commentary on Opposing Team's Initial Presentation (10 Points)

(1) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(2) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(3) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(4) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

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(9) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(10) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

Part 3: PRESENTING Team's Response to Opposing Team's Commentary (15 Points)

(1) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(2) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(3) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

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(14) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(15) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

Part 4: PRESENTING Team's Response to Judges' Questions (15 Points)

(1) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(2) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

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(13) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(14) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(15) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

Overall: Points for engaging in Respectful Dialogue, as opposed to Combative Debate (5 Points)

(1) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(2) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(3) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(4) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

(5) Did the team clearly identify and thoroughly discuss the central moral dimensions of the case?

TKEthics Invitational Score Sheet

Team A (presenting first):
Team Name: KANT

Team B (presenting second):
Team Name: MENCIUS

Team A Presentation (Case 1)	Team B Presentation (Case 2)
a. Addressed the question (1-5): 4	a. Addressed the question (1-5): 5
b. Ethical dimensions discussed (1-5): 4	b. Ethical dimensions discussed (1-5): 5
c. Considered multiple viewpoints (1-5): 3	c. Considered multiple viewpoints (1-5): 3
Subtotal: 11/15	Subtotal: 14/15
Response to Commentary: 12/15	Response to Commentary: 14/15
Response to Judges' Questions: 13.5/15	Response to Judges' Questions: 14/15
Commentary on Other Team: 9/10	Commentary on Other Team: 9/10
Respectful Dialogue: 5/5	Respectful Dialogue: 5/5
TOTAL: 50.5/60	TOTAL: 56/60
Comments for Team A:	Comments for Team B:

Your team had great teamwork and it was obvious you were all contributing which led to a diversity of ideas and a stronger final presentation. Arguments and examples were clearly thought out. Remember it is better to speak slower and clearer and perhaps say less than to speak very fast but lose clarity (and potentially time if you stumble over words). I would have liked to hear more about your framework and how it applied to this case in the initial introduction, but it was teased out well in your responses to

Very strong presentation both in content and delivery. Teamwork was strong and your argument was well developed. It was clear you understood your ethical framework and how it applied to your case, and you were consistent in applying this framework to the other team's questioning and my own. Remember that presenting counterarguments is important as it helps you highlight how you have thought of all dimensions of the case and can preempt difficult questions from the other team. Counterarguments can come

Timelines/Schedules

We hope to send an invitation letter to all prospective participants in various UWCs at the beginning of our school term (August 2026) to provide ample time for teams to form and for the confirmation of attendance, payments and judges.

Here is our suggested timetable for the online event:

- 18:00–18:30 Registration
- 18:30–19:00 Opening and briefing
- 19:00–20:00 Round 1
- 20:15–21:15 Round 2

- 21:30–22:30 Round 3
- 22:45–23:45 Round 4
- 23:45–24:15 Awards and closing

Official Competition Rules

Teams

- Remember, this is not a debate. Teams can agree with each other's position.
- Teams should consist of not more than 5 members and no less than three members.
- At the start of each heat, fresh scrap paper will be needed for team members to make notes during the match, but pre-prepared notes and any other materials are prohibited.
- Please make sure your 'microphone' is turned off unless your team is invited to speak by the moderator/judge during your assigned times.
- During private conferences (the 2-minute conference or one-minute conference), students should ideally be located in one room, in which case they can turn their microphone off. If team members are located in multiple locations due to a covid lockdown, they will need to organise a separate online forum for team meetings. If they are using this facility, they must not be speaking on that forum at any time apart from the allotted team conference times.
- The moderator/judge will keep the official time of each period of the match. Teams may use their own timers with the following restrictions and conditions: the timer cannot be any device that stores data or connects to the internet and a team may not time the portions of the match when the other team speaks or confers.
- Students do not have to be familiar with Ethical theories in order to participate in the event. However, they are encouraged to explore alternate positions to the position they take.
- We urge teams to provide an outline of their presentation when it begins—that is, the team should explain who will be discussing which aspect(s) of the case and why. This way, a moderator/judge will know what kind of presentation to expect.
- Students are encouraged to read the cases carefully beforehand and the linked resources to understand the full breadth of the cases, determine their positions, and make the strongest possible presentation. Although teams may use outside research to prepare for a match, they should not assume that merely presenting factual information will impress the judges. Teams need to propose valid, sound, persuasive arguments that are buttressed by facts to score well. If a team introduces a specific fact not contained in the case, the team should cite the source (e.g. "according to a 2011 article in National Geographic...").

Moderator/Judges

- Should direct their questions to teams based on the discussion, not to individuals.
- The moderator/judge can allow a team to finish a sentence once time has expired.
- A timer will be used which everyone can see. But if, for some reason, that is not working, teams will get two standardised time notifications from the moderator/judge during their presentations: one three-minute warning and one when one-minute warning.

- The moderator/judge controls the room during matches and should address any unacceptable behaviour, including, but not limited to: Coaches, parents, or audience members communicating—verbally or non-verbally.
- If there are outside distractions, noise interference, it is up to the moderator/judge, not a coach or a parent, to decide if the round should be paused.
- Teams must answer the case question during their presentation period. Teams are judged and scored on how well their members clearly and systematically address and respond to the question asked.
- Teams will not be penalised or rewarded, whether one person speaks or everyone in the team contributes. Judges should neither penalise nor reward a team for using either approach: both are welcome.
- When one team confers or speaks, the other team and any audience members must remain silent, although writing and passing notes is permitted. (For example, when Team A is given the case and question, they are allowed to confer for two minutes and then present for five minutes. During those five minutes, Team B is permitted to write notes but must remain silent.
- The decisions of the moderator/judges are final, and the heats will be totalled at the end of the day, and the results will be publicised within 24 hours. Where there is a tie, the Head judge will select the winner from the following process. The highest scores in the first heat....if that is still a draw, the highest score in the second heat and so on.
- If there is a complaint or challenge to the results, this should be put in writing to the organisers.
- The results will be emailed to supervising teachers and moderator/judges.

More info refer to: <https://www.modusponensinstitute.com/resources> and https://drive.google.com/file/d/1jvnLBht774jxy8x92Th_WPomrkHuxQK-/view?usp=drive_link (judge and participation guide)

TKEthics Collaboration

We hope to collaborate with and source judges from the well-known organisation [TKEthics](#), for judges, the number of judges will be half the number of teams plus one reserved judge in case of incidence. Me and my other leaders of MPEO society will take on the roles of operating scoring, equity, admin and response to general communications by ourselves, so no need for external support here. There will be 5 people minimum responsible for these roles.

5 Possible Judges background, additional judges will all come from the judging pool of TKE with similar leveled background:

1. Archie Stapleton
 - a. Archie Stapleton recently completed a Masters in Theological Studies at Harvard University, focusing on Indian Philosophy and Sanskrit. He has coached debate for over 7 years, taking students to the break rounds at Stanford, Harvard, Yale, and Georgetown. He previously taught Western Philosophy and Debate in Himachal Pradesh, India. Now based in Cambridge, MA, he leads MPI as a co-founder.

2. Zach Bloom

- a. Zach recently completed his Master's in Philosophy from UBC, receiving the Canada Graduate Scholarship-Master's Award for his research in mathematical ontology. He specialises in formal logic and metaphysics, but has extensively studied ethics and political philosophy. For over five years, Zach has professionally coached debate, earning major victories for his students across North America and China.

Other judges please refer to this link:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1mHqdBIAtyDEahSKQZ1JD3eN1bObN5T2i/view?usp=drive_link

Pricing

Based on an estimate from previous TKEthics competitions our leadership team has participated in, the price per team (4-5 people) would be around 120 USD. As the olympiad will be hosted on Zoom, what we would require is permission for participants to be off-timetable throughout the duration of the competition, as well as 40USD for the usage of the [Tabbycat](#) software. Tabbycat is a widely-used, free and open-source web application designed to run parliamentary debate tournaments. Closer to the proposed date, we would be able to get an estimate for the amount needed for the TKEthics judges to then divide the total price between all participants, who we suggest will pay for their participation in the tournament themselves if this event is not something that the Activities department will be able to fund.

More specific info and TKE service quotation can be found here:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1BvdtD49G81QqF8-m1SRT8qY0H3hMlCnu/view?usp=drive_link

TKE official website here: <https://www.tkethics.org/> ;
<https://www.modusponensinstitute.com/about-us>

About TKEthics:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1d-dv1D7XPgREcr_CR_uK-0ptRABasyDB/view?usp=drive_link

Budget:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1jHJYP1x3N3n8jl_fsFMld0g9yMBaDgSB32lbYzTwrFs/edit?usp=sharing

Requirements :

Team Formation Requirements:

- 3–5 members per team

- Grade 7 or above
- Members may be from different grade levels; however, cross-school teams are not recommended
- Participants are expected to have a background in philosophy or experience in debate competitions.

Participation Requirements:

- On the event day, a stable internet connection is required
- Team members may join the competition together from the same location using a single Zoom connection, or participate individually from separate devices
- Team members joining from different devices must have access to an instant communication tool for real-time coordination

Quotation:

All prices in USD and exclusive of applicable taxes or bank transfer fees. Line items A–G form the standard Turn-Key Delivery Package; individual lines can be removed or replaced on request before contract signature.

Line Item	Qty	Unit Price (USD)	Subtotal (USD)
Tournament operations (including scoring platform access, host and judges fee) (Optional)	8-32 teams	120.00	960-3,840.00
Subtotal			3,840
Total (single event, after discount)			3,840

School

list: <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1k0h922nLIpaM23ajOsYUlnS6NJ3rIDjcuRL9RXvarQQ/edit?gid=1610237978#gid=1610237978>

Invitation letter:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1JgVte4Tq4N6zEO0DP0cfxX9KaRYt_fFe2CXFi5kmBD0/edit?tab=t.0#heading=h.xqh1r0c1zkyr

Express of interest by this date -> form

TIME LINE

22 Sept - Sent the express of interest form

6 Oct - Close

6 Oct - Open registration- Registration form

26 Oct - Close

More than 8 team

29 Oct - Sending the case package for the tournament

21 Nov- Competition

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1k0h922nLlpaM23ajOsYUlnS6NJ3rIDjcuRL9RXvarQQ/edit?gid=1610237978#gid=1610237978>

1. Propose of interest form
2. Registration form
3. Website
4. Change school list
- 5.